

Hesai Group (HSAI/2525.HK): Asia Leaders Conference 2026 Takeaways: Strategic entry into physical AI supported by vertical integration

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Bottom line: We hosted Hesai management at our Asia Leaders Conference 2026 in Hong Kong.

Key takeaways:

- **ADAS LiDAR growth supported by increasing penetration and multi-sensor adoption:** Driven by the upcoming rollout of L3 autonomous driving regulations in July next year in China, Hesai sees a surge in design wins for high-resolution and full-color LiDARs (target for mass production in 2H26). The company also expects more OEMs to adopt multi-sensor configurations per vehicle, evidenced by Li Auto, Xiaomi, and ChangAn. Moreover, Hesai's full-color technology resolves timestamp synchronization conflicts with cameras. This momentum is further validated by expanding partnerships with global OEMs, including Mercedes-Benz and joint ventures involving Toyota, GM, and Audi, as well as Chinese automakers expanding overseas.
- **Robust LiDAR demand from robotics:** Positioning itself as a critical infrastructure provider for the embodied AI revolution, Hesai is supplying LiDARs to over 50 humanoid robotics companies, noting that robotic applications require more than ten times the LiDAR volume of ADAS. The company sees ample room for the non-automotive segment with majority revenue from overseas robotaxi segments with ASPs reaching several thousand dollars. To support this global demand and navigate geopolitical complexities, Hesai's Thailand facility will complete its hardware construction by YE.
- **Strategic entry into 3D Spatial Data and AI Infrastructure via KOSMO:** Hesai is diversifying beyond automotive hardware with KOSMO, a high-margin (over 40%) spatial data solution combining LiDAR with cameras to capture high-fidelity 3D environments. The company started KOSMO delivery since July, targeting robot pre-training for companies like Galbot and Manycore Tech, as well as virtual production in the film industry. Priced at around Rmb100k per unit, KOSMO is projected to generate tens of millions in revenue this year, scaling

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to hundreds of millions next year. The company sees hardware gross margin of 40%+, with further upside from recurring revenue.

- **Vertical Integration in robotics actuation module:** The company is constructive on robotics actuation module potential, with expectation of 1) 10bn humanoid robots delivery across the world in the long term, 2) around 100 joints per robot, 3) actuation accounting for half of a humanoid robot's bill of materials. Hesai is leveraging its in-house manufacturing capabilities and relationship with Sharp to produce high-performance motors and dexterous hands, avoiding the assembly-only model of some peers. Moreover, the company has plans to expand to shoulder joint and wrist joint in the near future.

Investment Thesis

We are Buy rated on Hesai (H/ADR), a leading LiDAR solutions provider. Its products cater to applications across advanced driver assistance systems (ADAS), autonomous mobility, and robotics with 33% revenue market share in 2024 globally. We believe Hesai is well-positioned to benefit from (1) China NEV market's ongoing NOA (navigation on autopilot) adoption acceleration starting from 2025, together with the launch of lower-cost products, to drive LiDAR usage in mass-market vehicle models; (2) overseas ADAS opportunities, gaining design-wins from global OEMs with mass production positioned to begin 2026E/2027E; and (3) global robotaxi/robotics market, with 61% of global robotaxi market share in 2024, and incremental orders from other verticals such as automatic lawn mowers. In addition, Hesai is entering the harvesting stage of its next gen ATX product with a 3-year product cycle starting from 2025, driving growing scale and operating leverage to achieve revenue growth acceleration and a strong profit CAGR. We believe Hesai's valuation is attractive - currently trading at a below 12m fwd average 2026E P/E against 80% earnings growth in 2026E. Key catalysts: new design wins, OEM new model launches with LiDAR, and quarterly results. Key risks: slower LiDAR adoption, intensified competition, customer pricing pressure, policy risk.

Price Target Risks & Methodology

Our 12m target prices of US\$31/HK\$30 for the ADR/H share are based on a 20x P/E multiple applied to Hesai's 2030E non-GAAP EPS and discounted back to 2026E at a CoE of 11%. Risks include slower LiDAR adoption, intensified competition, customer pricing pressure, and policy risk.

2525.HK	12m Price Target: HK\$30	Price: HK\$16.32	Upside: 83.8%			
HSAI	12m Price Target: \$31	Price: \$17.42	Upside: 78%			
Buy	GS Forecast					
		12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E	
	Market cap: \$22.7bn	Revenue (Rmb mn)	3,027.6	4,143.9	5,612.1	7,194.3
	Enterprise value: \$22.2bn	EBITDA (Rmb mn)	292.5	402.8	771.0	1,145.5
	3m ADTV \$31.6mn	EPS (Rmb)	3.96	0.44	0.70	0.98
	China	P/E (X)	36.9	NM	168.0	119.9
	China Mobility Tech	P/B (X)	2.6	16.3	15.1	13.8
		Dividend yield (%)	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
	M&A Rank: 3	N debt/EBITDA (ex lease,X)	(22.0)	63.4	3.5	0.6
	Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: Yes	CROCI (%)	12.0	6.5	11.4	14.5
		FCF yield (%)	(1.1)	(0.1)	0.0	0.2
			3/26	6/26	9/26E	12/26E
		EPS (Rmb)	0.04	0.08	0.12	0.20

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 28 Aug 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

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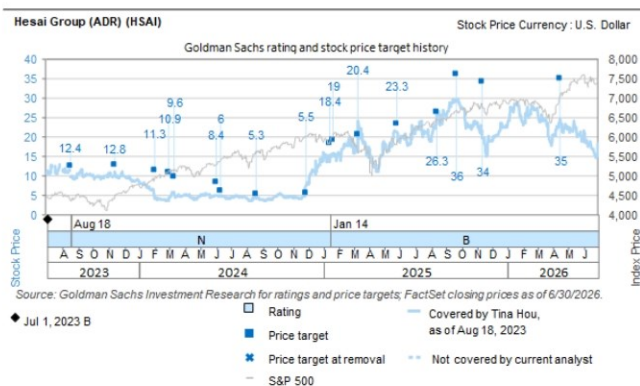
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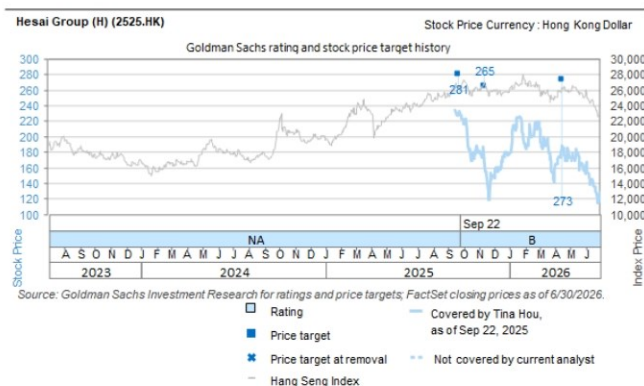
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Target price history table(s)

Hesai Group (H) (2525.HK)

Date of report	Target price (HK\$)	Closing price (HK\$)
20-Aug-26	30.00	18.19
17-Apr-26	273.00	23.25
13-Nov-25	265.00	21.19
22-Sep-25	281.00	28.88

Hesai Group (ADR) (HSAI)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
20-Aug-26	31.00	18.62
17-Apr-26	35.00	23.25
13-Nov-25	34.00	19.78
22-Sep-25	36.00	29.71
15-Aug-25	26.30	25.59
27-May-25	23.30	21.26
11-Mar-25	20.40	24.08
21-Jan-25	19.00	15.91
14-Jan-25	18.40	15.00
27-Nov-24	5.50	7.35
20-Aug-24	5.30	4.17
11-Jun-24	6.00	4.89
03-Jun-24	8.40	4.84
12-Mar-24	9.60	5.16
01-Mar-24	10.90	4.44
02-Feb-24	11.30	4.15
14-Nov-23	12.80	11.00

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